Keystone Bookkeepers — Diligence Workbook Formula Review

AMB + Topkey — Diligence Workbook v6.xlsx

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Summary

The workbook was reviewed cell-by-cell across all 13 tabs (7,914 formulas) using a LibreOffice recalculation pass plus targeted structural checks (SUM/aggregate range spans, row-relative formula-pattern consistency, cross-sheet reference validity, and hardcoded-value detection). Five issues were found, summarized below and detailed in the next section.

#	Severity	Tab(s)	Issue
1	**High**	Revenue Analysis	9 cells (G38:G46) contain a broken reference — literal #REF! baked into the formula, throwing a hard error.
2	**High**	Combined P&L, P&L Forecast, P&L Overview	Both LTM columns are anchored one month early. "Jul'26 LTM" silently excludes the most recent actual month (Jul 2026) and overstates Net Income by ~$32K (31%).
3	**Moderate**	Revenue Analysis	C46 sums 8 blank growth-rate cells instead of computing a growth ratio like its row-siblings — currently masked as 0, not a genuine error value.
4	**Moderate**	Combined P&L	Tie-Out / Check section columns are out of visual order (FY2024/FY2025 sub-columns interleaved) — numbers are still correct, but the layout misleads on a skim.
5	**Low**	Revenue Analysis; Combined P&L / P&L Forecast	Orphaned leftover cells carrying the same date typo (harmless); "July'26 YTD" has no upper-bound safeguard once August 2026+ data is added.

Detailed Findings

Finding 1 — Broken reference in Revenue Analysis, column G (rows 38–46) [HIGH]

Cells G38 through G46 (the "Recurring Revenue % Growth" block) all contain the same corrupted formula:

```
=IFERROR('p&l overview'!#REF!/'p&l overview'!#REF!-1,0)
```

The lowercase sheet name and the literal #REF! text indicate a row or column was deleted on the P&L Overview tab at some point, breaking whatever cell this formula used to point to — Excel/Sheets bakes the deleted reference in as #REF! rather than silently repairing it. On recalculation this throws a hard #VALUE! error in all 9 cells (confirmed via LibreOffice recalculation: 9 of 9 total formula errors found workbook-wide are in this block). The IFERROR wrapper does not catch it, so these cells will show an error indicator when opened.

Row 46 ("Recurring Revenue Growth", the block's total line) also references this broken cell and is affected.

Recommended fix: re-point each formula to the correct prior-period cell on P&L Overview (or, more robustly, replace with a same-tab calculation consistent with columns D/E/H/I in the same rows, e.g. referencing the corresponding prior-month column here rather than a separate tab).

Finding 2 — LTM columns are anchored one month early (dates off by a month, in three places) [HIGH]

The "Jul'25 LTM" and "Jul'26 LTM" columns are meant to sum the trailing twelve months ending in July of each year (Aug'24–Jul'25, and Aug'25–Jul'26). Instead, the anchor date that drives both windows is hardcoded to June 30 instead of July 31:

- Combined P&L!K116 = 6/30/2024 (should be 7/31/2024)
- P&L Forecast!I172 = 6/30/2024 (should be 7/31/2024) — the same typo, independently present in a second tab

Because L116 and J172 (the "Jul'26 LTM" start dates) are each formulas that chain off the cell above (=K117 / =I173), the error cascades: both LTM windows run from July of the prior year through June of the labeled year, not August through July as labeled. Concretely:

- "Jul'25 LTM" currently sums Jul'24–Jun'25, not Aug'24–Jul'25
- "Jul'26 LTM" currently sums Jul'25–Jun'26, not Aug'25–Jul'26 — meaning it silently drops the most recent month of actual data (July 2026) and instead includes July 2025 a second time (July 2025 is already fully captured by "Jul'25 LTM" and by FY2025).

P&L Overview's own "LTM" columns (I8, J8, etc.) pull straight from P&L Forecast's I/J columns, so they inherit the same wrong figures without a separate bug of their own — worth knowing since P&L Overview is likely the tab a reader sees first.

This is quantifiable and material. Recomputing the correct Aug–Jul windows directly from the monthly grid gives ($000s):

Metric ($000s)	Shown "Jul'25 LTM" (really Jul'24–Jun'25)	Correct Aug'24–Jul'25	Shown "Jul'26 LTM" (really Jul'25–Jun'26)	Correct Aug'25–Jul'26
Total Income	1,473.7	1,524.4	2,456.5	**2,552.5**
Total COGS	888.4	916.6	1,345.2	**1,394.7**
Gross Profit	585.3	607.8	1,111.2	**1,157.8**
Total Expenses	427.9	460.4	960.2	**1,039.0**
Net Operating Income	157.4	147.4	151.0	**118.8**
Net Income	145.4	135.0	135.2	**103.3**

Net Income under the currently-shown "Jul'26 LTM" is overstated by roughly $32K (31%) relative to the correct trailing-twelve-months figure, and Total Income is understated by roughly $96K. Given LTM figures typically anchor valuation multiples in a buy-side process, this is worth correcting before the workbook goes further.

*Recommended fix: change Combined P&L!K116 and P&L Forecast!I172 from 6/30/2024 to 7/31/2024. Because L116/J172 and the *117/*173 rows chain off these cells via EOMONTH(...,12), fixing the two anchor cells should correct both LTM columns in both tabs automatically — worth a spot recalculation check afterward.*

Finding 3 — Revenue Analysis!C46 formula doesn't match its row [MODERATE]

Row 46 ("Recurring Revenue Growth") computes each period's total-revenue growth rate as =IFERROR(<this period>16/<prior period>16-1,0) in columns D, E, G, H and I. Column C, however, reads =SUM(C38:C45) — the sum of eight individual line-item growth percentages directly above it, which is not a meaningful figure (summing percentage growth rates across different revenue lines doesn't equal the total's growth rate). It currently evaluates to 0 because C38:C45 are blank (there's no prior period to compare the first column against), so it happens to look like an unremarkable "0%," but the formula itself is the wrong shape and would produce a nonsensical number if those cells were ever populated.

Recommended fix: either leave C46 blank (there is no prior period for the first column, consistent with C38:C45 being blank) or make it =IFERROR(C16/B16-1,0) to match the pattern used in D46 onward, if B16 is a valid comparison base.

Finding 4 — Combined P&L Tie-Out section: columns out of order [MODERATE]

In the Tie-Out / Check block at the bottom of Combined P&L (rows 120–130), the FY2024 and FY2025 sub-columns are interleaved rather than grouped: reading left to right, the order is FY2024 Combined (E) → FY2024 Raw Total (F) → FY2025 Raw Total (H) → FY2025 Diff (I) → FY2024 Diff (K) → FY2025 Combined (L). The block headers in rows 120–121 don't sit above their matching data columns as a result. FY2026 YTD (columns N–P) is unaffected and reads correctly.

I traced every formula in this section individually — E122 through Q130 all reference the correct cells for their own comparison (for example K122 = E122−F122 is genuinely the FY2024 diff, just displayed out of sequence), and every "Status" cell correctly reads "TIES OUT." So the reconciliation itself is accurate; only the presentation is scrambled, most likely from the "Summary Account" / "Personal?" / "July'25 YTD" columns having been inserted into the sheet without the Tie-Out block below being re-laid-out to match.

Recommended fix: reorder columns E–P in rows 120–130 (and their headers) into clean FY2024 / FY2025 / FY2026 YTD groups of three (Combined, Raw Tab Total, Diff) so the section reads correctly at a glance.

Finding 5 — Minor / informational **[LOW]**

- Revenue Analysis!C52:D53 carries the same 6/30/2024 date typo described in Finding 2 (=EOMONTH chain, mirroring Combined P&L!K116/K117). Nothing else in the workbook references these four cells, so they don't affect any displayed number — they appear to be leftover scaffolding. Worth deleting or fixing for consistency, but not urgent.
- The "July'26 YTD" column (Combined P&L!I117, P&L Forecast!G173) has no upper-bound safeguard the way "July'25 YTD" does — its end boundary is 12/31/2026 rather than a hardcoded 7/31/2026. It reads correctly today only because no data exists past July 2026 yet. Once August 2026+ actuals are added, this column will silently stop being a "through July" figure unless someone hardcodes the cutoff the same way it was done for July'25 YTD.

Scope & Methodology

All 13 tabs were checked: Cover, P&L Overview, P&L Forecast, Revenue Analysis, Revenue Charts, Expense Charts, Raw Data → (divider), Customer List, Software, Combined P&L, and the three Raw – 20XX PL tabs.

- Full-workbook LibreOffice recalculation (7,914 formulas), scanning for #REF!/#VALUE!/#DIV/0!/#NAME?/#N/A/#NULL!/#NUM! results — found the 9 cells in Finding 1 and nothing else.
- A text scan of every formula for literal error tokens (e.g. #REF!) baked into the formula string itself, to catch errors an IFERROR wrapper might otherwise mask — confirmed no cells beyond Finding 1's nine.
- A row-by-row check that every SUM/AVERAGE/COUNT-style aggregate spans the same range as its neighbors in that row (catches the classic "a column's total range didn't update when a row was inserted" bug) — no mismatches found anywhere in the workbook.
- A row-by-row check of same-sheet relative cell references, flagging any cell whose reference pattern breaks from its row's otherwise-consistent shape — surfaced Finding 1 and Finding 3, plus several "Delta ($)/Delta (%)" and SUMIFS-by-date-range columns in P&L Overview, P&L Forecast, and Combined P&L that were investigated and confirmed to be intentional design, not errors.
- A scan for hardcoded numeric values sitting inside otherwise formula-driven grids (Combined P&L's monthly grid and P&L Forecast's monthly grid) — none found; every monthly cell in both grids is a live formula.
- Validation that every cross-sheet reference in the workbook points to a sheet name that actually exists — no dangling sheet references found.
- Manual tracing of the cross-tab data flow: Combined P&L's "Summary Account" and "Personal?" tag columns feed P&L Forecast's SUMIFS roll-up, which in turn feeds P&L Overview — confirmed every tag used in Combined P&L has a matching category in P&L Forecast (no line items are silently dropped from the roll-up), and confirmed the QoE personal-expense addback rows are correctly wired via the "Personal?" column rather than being placeholder/dead rows.

Not covered: the numeric accuracy of hardcoded inputs and assumptions themselves (e.g., whether a specific dollar figure a person typed in is correct) — only whether formulas compute correctly from whatever inputs are present. Chart objects were not evaluated beyond confirming their formulas; a few combo (bar+line) charts on Revenue Charts / Expense Charts produce a benign parser warning in the Python library used for this review, which is a known limitation of that library reading multi-series charts, not a sign of a damaged file.